couplets, ten to each chapter, are easy to remember and full of good sense.



The statue of Thiruvalluvar outside the School of Oriental and African Studies in London, unveiled in 1996 with the Indian High Commissioner in attendance.

Thiruvalluvar first entered my consciousness as a larger-than-life-size grey painted statue seated cross-legged on the lawn outside the library of the School of Oriental and African Studies in London. Its erection there in 1996 was first and last a political statement, as is that much larger representation off Kanyakumari. Both are expressions of Tamil India’s growing self-assertion. When Chief Minister Dr K. Karunanidhi allocated funds for the Indian statue in 1990 he was cocking a snook at Northern India on behalf of the South and his own regionalist political party, the Dravida